

PM Modi pitches open source digital platforms for the Global South at CSPOC



PM Modi launches CSPOC with push for open source technology platforms for the Global South

Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated the 28th Conference of Speakers and Presiding Officers of the Commonwealth (CSPOC) on January 15, 2026, at the Central Hall of Samvidhan Sadan, Parliament House Complex, New Delhi, positioning open source digital platforms as a key pillar of India's engagement with the Global South.

Delivering the keynote address at the inaugural session, PM Modi underlined India's commitment to building open source technology platforms that enable Commonwealth and Global South nations to develop digital governance systems comparable to India's, while reducing reliance on proprietary technology ecosystems.

"This is the fourth time the Commonwealth Speakers and Presiding Officers Conference is being held in India. This year's theme—'Effective Delivery of Parliamentary Democracy'—is highly relevant in today's global context," Modi said.

On technology and development, the PM said, "India's continuous effort is to ensure that whatever innovations we make benefit the entire Global South. We are also creating open source tech platforms so that our partner countries in the Global South can develop systems like those in India."

The conference, hosted by the Parliament of India in coordination with the CSPOC Secretariat, ran from January 14-16, 2026, and brought together 61 speakers and presiding officers from 42 Commonwealth parliaments.

IBM launches Sovereign Core to aid digital sovereignty

IBM has announced IBM Sovereign Core, describing it as the industry's first AI-ready, sovereign-enabled software built on open source foundations to help enterprises, governments, and service providers build, deploy, and manage sovereign AI environments.

YourStory and Meta unveil 'Bharat Builds With Llama' docu-reel series

YourStory, in collaboration with Meta, has launched 'Bharat Builds With Llama', a short-form docu-reel series that highlights how Indian startups are harnessing open source Llama models to tackle India-specific, real-world challenges.

Each episode, roughly two minutes long, follows a single applied use case in its actual working environment, showing AI already in action rather than promising futuristic breakthroughs. The series captures the grassroots innovation of early Indian builders fine-tuning open source models for local languages, diverse contexts, and resource-limited environments.

The featured startups span multiple sectors, including health information tools, multilingual learning support, legal documentation, accessibility solutions, and customer operations. They demonstrate AI applied to simplifying everyday tasks, improving access to information, and increasing efficiency in traditionally underserved or complex systems.

What makes the series uniquely Indian is the problem-solving under real-world constraints, unreliable infrastructure, diverse languages, limited resources, and legacy systems not built for AI.

